

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR
EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case No. 2013-2227

STIPULATION AND FINAL AGENCY ORDER

IN THE MATTER OF DISCIPLINARY PROCEEDINGS REGARDING THE LICENSE TO
PRACTICE PROFESSIONAL COUNSELING IN THE STATE OF COLORADO OF HEIDI
BENDELL, LICENSE NO. LPC 268,

Respondent.

IT IS HEREBY STIPULATED by and between the State Board of Licensed Professional
Counselor Examiners ("Board") and Heidi Bendell ("Respondent"), as follows:

1. Respondent was licensed to practice as a professional counselor ("LPC") in the State of Colorado on October 20, 1990, having been issued license number LPC 268, and is currently so licensed.
2. The Board has jurisdiction over Respondent and the subject matter of this Stipulation and Final Agency Order ("Order").
3. It is the intent of the parties and the purpose of this Order to provide for a settlement of all matters arising out of the complaints in case number 2013-2227 without the necessity of holding a formal hearing. This Order is a full and final resolution of case number 2013-2227. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Board or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.
4. Respondent admits the following:
 - a. On or around November 2012, Respondent began providing couples counseling at the same time she was counseling each individual separately.
 - b. The Board's policy regarding dual relationships states: "Dual or multiple relationships occur when a professional assumes two or more roles at the same time or sequentially with a client or with someone who has a significant relationship with the client, which includes providing couples counseling and individual therapy to the same person(s) at the same time."
 - c. Respondent engaged in dual relationships with clients when it was likely to impair her professional judgment or increase the risk of client exploitation.

5. By virtue of the admissions in paragraph 4, Respondent is subject to the following disciplinary sanction(s) that the Board believes is necessary to protect the public health, safety, and welfare.

ADMONISHMENT

6. On the basis of the findings set forth in paragraphs 4 and 5, the Board hereby admonishes Respondent for violation of §12-43-222(1)(g) and (i), C.R.S. This Order is effective as a Letter of Admonition, set forth by §12-43-224(3)(d), C.R.S. As part of the admonishment, Respondent agrees to the following terms as a Board Order:

CONTINUING EDUCATION

7. Respondent must successfully complete twenty (20) hours of Board-approved professional continuing education (CE) courses in the areas of dual relationships, confidentiality, and conflicts of interest. Respondent shall obtain Board approval of the courses prior to enrolling in each course. Upon completion of a course, Respondent shall ensure that a certificate of completion is provided to the Board. These hours of CE completed pursuant to this section shall be required in addition to, and may not be counted toward, the mandatory Continuing Professional Development requirements for an active Colorado license or to meet any other licensure requirements.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

8. Respondent will strictly observe the prohibitions set forth in §12-43-222, C.R.S., and will ensure that she does not engage in any activities that are prohibited and that she practices in accordance with the generally accepted standards of practice.

9. Respondent shall not supervise or consult with other mental health providers for the purpose of those persons providing mental health services, unless such supervision or consultation is monitored in accordance with this Order.

10. All expenses incurred or associated with education or any other requirement necessary to fulfill the terms of this Order, shall be the sole responsibility of Respondent and not the Board.

11. In the event Respondent relocates at any time during the probationary period, Respondent shall notify the Board of the change of address within 30 days of the effective date of such change.

12. Respondent is fully aware of and understands the right to receive a formal notice of hearing and charges and to have a formal disciplinary hearing, pursuant to § 12-43-224, C.R.S., and hereby waives those rights. Further, Respondent also acknowledges that this waiver constitutes a waiver of all rights to appeal in this matter.

13. This Order is entered into by Respondent voluntarily and without coercion, after an opportunity to consult with counsel and with full understanding of the legal consequences of this Order and the right to formal hearing on all matters herein.

14. This Order shall become an order of the Board when it is accepted and signed by the Program Director or authorized Board representative.

15. The Order entered pursuant to this Stipulation and Final Agency Order shall constitute a Board order for purposes of §12-43-222, C.R.S., and shall have the same force and effect as an order entered after a formal disciplinary hearing pursuant to §12-43-224, C.R.S.

16. Respondent acknowledges and agrees that any violation of this Order shall constitute a violation of a lawful Board Order and be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to the Mental Health Practice Act and, if proven, may constitute a basis for further disciplinary action. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with the terms of this Order, and this Order shall remain operative and in full force and effect.

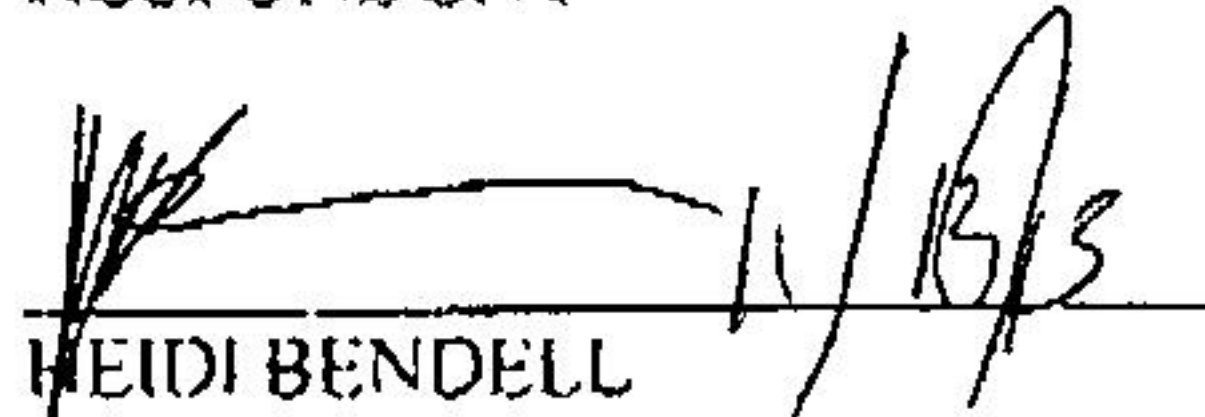
17. This Order constitutes the entire agreement between Respondent and the Board. There are no other promises expressed or implied. In the event that any provision of this Order is deemed unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction, such provision shall be severed, and the remainder of this Order shall be given full force and effect.

18. This Order shall become effective upon (a) mailing by first-class mail to Respondent at Respondent's address of record with the Board, or (b) service by electronic means on Respondent at Respondent's electronic address of record with the Board. Respondent hereby consents to service by electronic means if Respondent has an electronic address on file with the Board.

19. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Board.

AGREED TO AND ACCEPTED BY:

RESPONDENT


HEIDI BENDELL
LPC NO. 268

AGREED TO AND ORDERED BY:

**BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL
COUNSELOR EXAMINERS**


JACQUILINE ARCELIN
Program Director

Effective this 15th day of November 2013.